

This paper provides design techniques and suggestions for creating accessible Web content. Using the Microsoft FrontPage Web site creation and management tool, Web designers can reach the largest audience possible.

Specific Design Suggestions

These tips are intended to help you make your Web site more accessible. This is not a complete list, but it will offer some ideas and things to think about as you design and edit your Web site with Microsoft FrontPage 2002.

Use Single-Column Text

When developing a Web site, it is best to place all text in a single column. Multiple-column text is hard to read by most screen readers because they read text from left to right regardless of certain cells and formatting. Additionally, the single column approach is also best for serving visually impaired users who use screen magnification software.

For some types of sites, of course, this may not be practicable. If this is the case, consider providing an alternate linear version. For a multi-column table, to take an example, use separate paragraphs to represent the information in each cell, and sequence the paragraphs in the order that one would read them in the table.

Add Document Type Definitions to Better Define Your Document

Use a document type definition (DTD) at the beginning of your Web pages. DTDs are recognized by Web page validation tools as well as by Web browsers and assistive technologies. When you explain exactly what type of document your Web server is serving, the user's browsing technologies will be able to present that document in the most effective manner.

You can create a custom template that contains the DTD, so every document you create from that template will include the DTD. To do so: